

KEEP THIS ONE; IT'S BUILT TO LIVE IN YOUR GRADING SPOT

AI for Assessment: Rubrics, Feedback, and Question Banks

THE STANCE

AI drafts assessment materials. It never grades students, never sees student work with names attached, and never makes decisions about students.

AI drafts, the teacher decides.

The three red lines

- **AI never grades.** No score or decision about a student ever comes from a machine.
- **No student names or identifying work in public AI tools.** Kit 1's hard rule, always.
- **Feedback that reaches a student always passes through you.** Your eyes, your edits, then delivery.

The anonymous-excerpt rule: paste a bit of student work only if it has zero identifying details (Kit 1's test: no names, no classmates, no story a neighbor could recognize). When unsure, describe the pattern instead: "students keep confusing X with Y." Pattern beats paste; it's always safe and usually works as well.

Prompt 1 · Notes → rubric

"You are an experienced [grade/subject] teacher. Turn my notes into a 4-level analytic rubric (Beginning · Developing · Proficient · Advanced) for [assignment]. Criteria: [3–5 criteria]. Write every descriptor in language a [grade] grader can read, and make each level describe what the work does, not what it lacks. Format: a table with criteria down the side. Then ask me up to three questions about anything unclear in my notes." *[paste your notes]*

The hand-it-to-a-student test: read one descriptor aloud. Could a student tell you exactly what to do to move up one level? If not, iterate: "Rewrite level 2 so a student knows exactly what moving to level 3 requires."

Prompt 2 · Topic + misconception → question bank

"You are a [grade/subject] teacher. Build a 10-question bank on [topic] for students who commonly [misconception: confuse X with Y]. Mix: 6 multiple choice, 2 short answer, 2 extended response. In each multiple-choice question, make one distractor the misconception. Include a full answer key, then explain in one line why each distractor is wrong. Label each question with the skill it checks."

Vet everything, every time. Teachers in one study rated AI-drafted questions 97% on-topic, usefulness 3.6/4 (Elkins et al., 2023), with teacher vetting built into the process. The vetting pass: answer key correct? · any distractor accidentally true? · reading level right? · exactly one fair answer? · matches what you actually taught? Fix or delete at least one weak question by hand; there's almost always one.

Prompt 3 · Patterns → feedback starters

"Here are the three most common patterns in my students' [work type]: [pattern 1], [pattern 2], [pattern 3]. For each, draft a 2–3 sentence feedback comment that names something the writer did well, names the pattern plainly, and gives one concrete next step. Warm, specific, readable by a [grade] grader. I'll personalize every comment before a student sees it."

Starters, not stamps: before any comment reaches a student, add the sentence only you can write, the one that shows you read their work. Trained humans still beat ChatGPT on feedback quality (Steiss et al., 2024); the machine gives you a floor and a fast draft, you supply the ceiling.

Why the drafting is worth doing

- **Formative checks raise achievement** (~250 studies; Black & Wiliam), and more checks means more materials.
- **Rubrics have a moderate positive effect** on academic performance, and smaller, less certain effects on self-regulation (Panadero et al., 2023), if students can read them.
- **Sharp questions beat filler:** a distractor built from a real misconception tells you who holds it.

What AI can't do here

- **It can't know what a student was trying to do.** It sees the page; you saw the six weeks.
- **Its rubric language drifts generic.** Fix: feed it your assignment's specifics, by name.
- **Its question banks contain errors.** The teachers it helps are the ones who verify.

My three most common student patterns (draft them here)

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